

A Winner-Take-Most Market

What 1,000 self-reported startups reveal about revenue concentration, category value, and exit liquidity

CONTEXT

What Is TrustMRR?

A self-reported registry of indie and small-team startups, each verified against live payment data.

1,000

startups, each with 29 data points

8

major categories, led by AI and SaaS

26%

of listings are actively for sale

Two terms you'll see throughout

MRR

Monthly Recurring Revenue — the predictable income a company collects every month from active subscribers. It's the core health metric for subscription businesses.

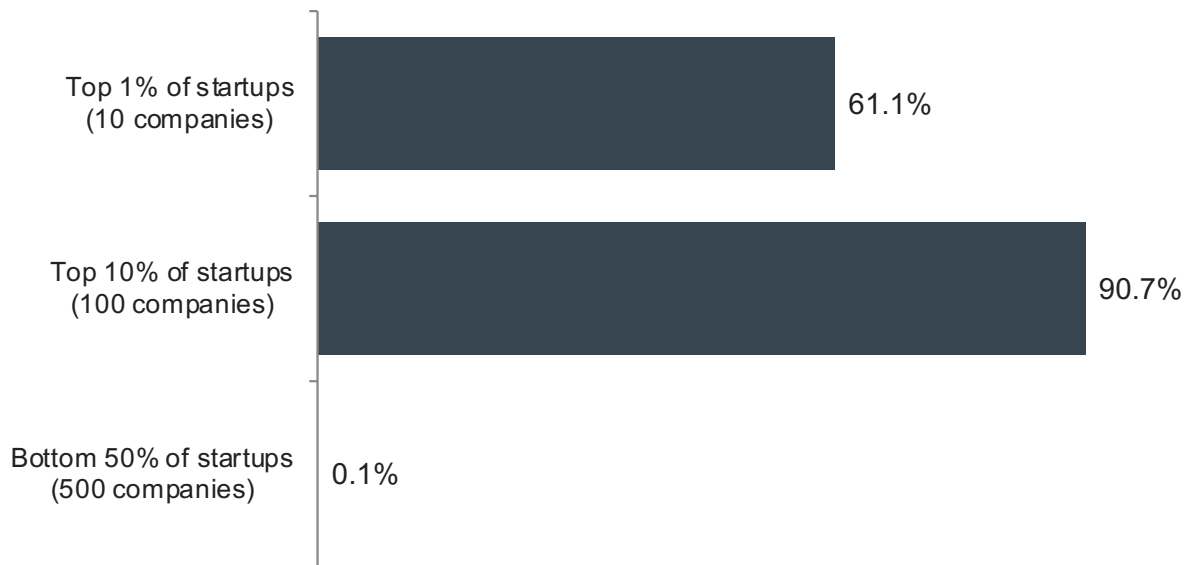
Revenue Multiple

When a startup is listed for sale, its asking price is expressed as a multiple of annual revenue (e.g., 3x). Higher multiples signal buyers expect stronger, more durable growth.

FINDING 01

A Few Winners Hold Nearly All the Revenue

Share of the dataset's \$334M in combined revenue, by slice of companies



The math

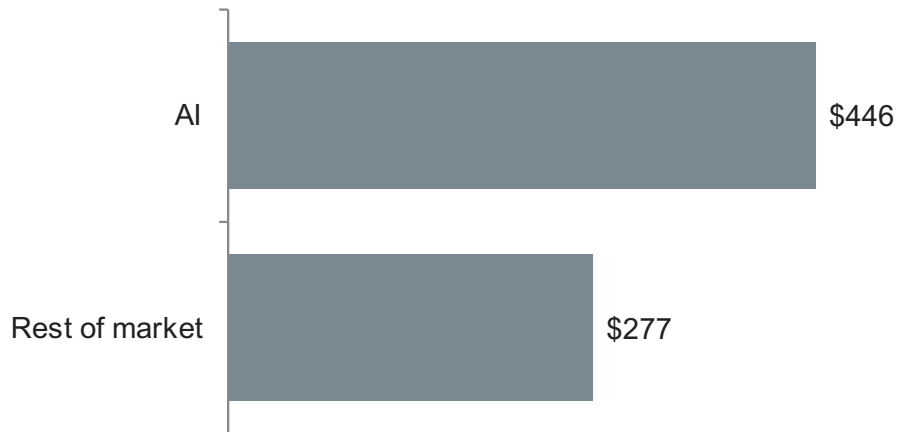
- The top 10 companies alone — 1% of the dataset — generate 61% of all revenue.
- The bottom 500 companies, half the dataset, generate barely a rounding error: 0.1%.
- This is a power-law distribution, not a bell curve — averages describing this market are misleading.

FINDING 02

AI Doesn't Just Lead in Volume — It Leads in Value

AI-tagged startups vs. every other category, on the two metrics buyers care about most

Median monthly revenue (MRR)



Median exit multiple (when listed for sale)

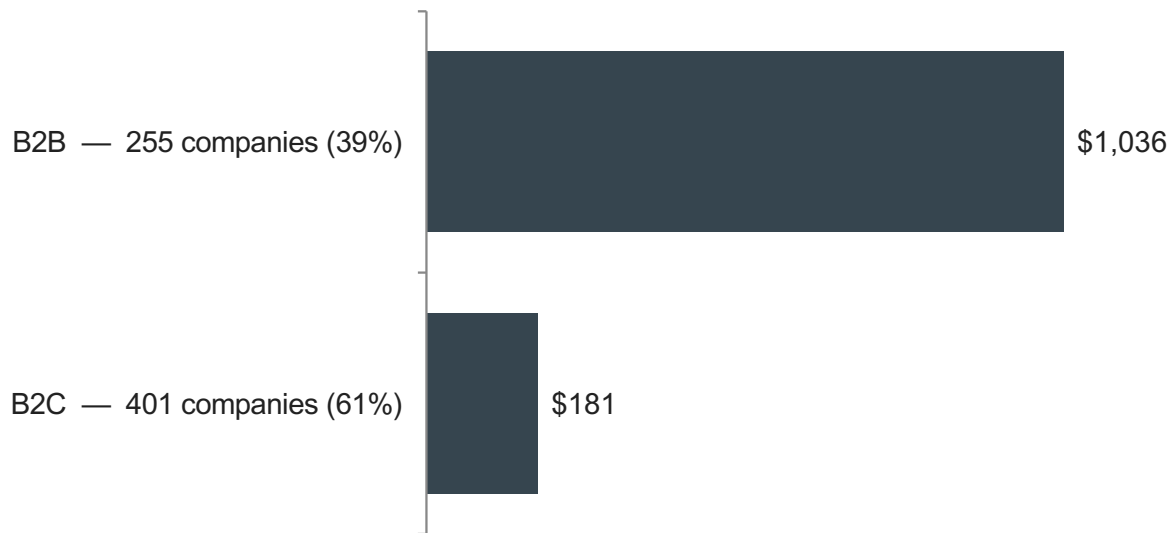


AI startups earn 61% more in typical monthly revenue and command a 37% higher resale multiple than the rest of the market — buyers are pricing in AI's durability, not just its hype.

FINDING 03

B2B Is Smaller in Numbers, Bigger in Money

Median MRR by audience type, among the 656 startups with a tagged audience



5.7x

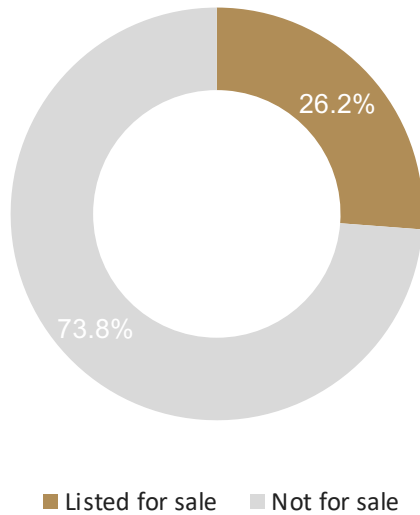
the revenue gap between a typical B2B and B2C startup

- B2C outnumbered B2B nearly 2 to 1 in listings — but generates far less per company.
- Fewer B2B customers pay more, and pay more reliably — the classic enterprise trade-off shows up clearly here.

FINDING 04

One in Four Startups Is Already for Sale

TrustMRR doubles as an active marketplace, not just a leaderboard



262

companies actively listed for sale

\$35,000

median asking price

2.3x

median asking price, as a multiple of annual revenue

THE TAKEAWAY

This Is a Power-Law Market, Not an Average One

- 1 Revenue is concentrated**

10 companies (1%) hold 61% of all revenue — the median startup is nearly irrelevant to the total.
- 2 Category matters**

AI startups out-earn and out-sell the rest of the market, commanding a real, measurable premium.
- 3 Fewer, larger buyers win**

B2B startups earn 5.7x more than B2C peers despite being outnumbered nearly 2 to 1.
- 4 The market is liquid**

A quarter of all listings are for sale today — TrustMRR functions as an active exit marketplace, not a static leaderboard.

Bottom line: don't build strategy around the average TrustMRR startup — build it around the traits of the outliers that actually win.